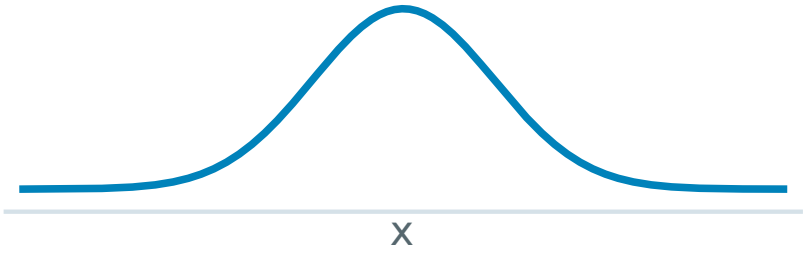
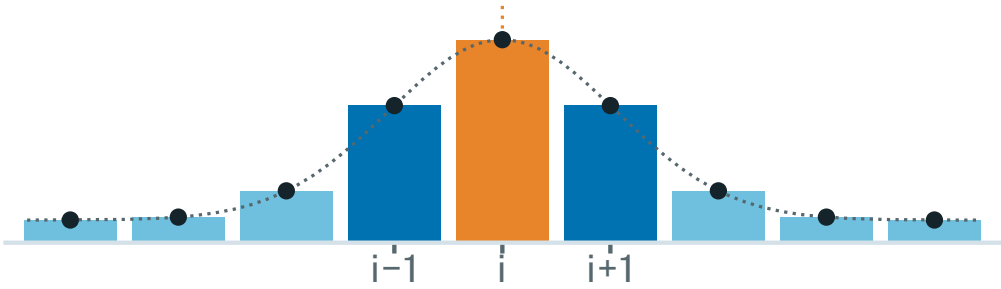
1 Continuous field $u(t_k, x)$

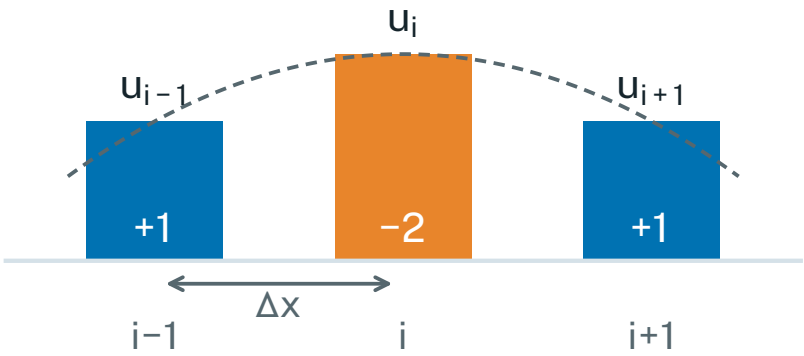


2 Discretise: grid values u_i^k

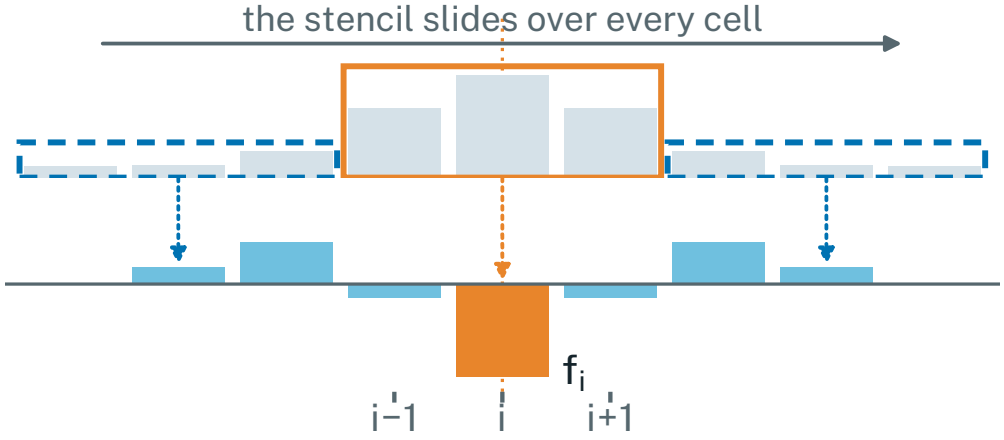


3 Stencil at cell i

$$f_i = [(+1)\,u_{i-1} + (-2)\,u_i + (+1)\,u_{i+1}]/\Delta x^2$$

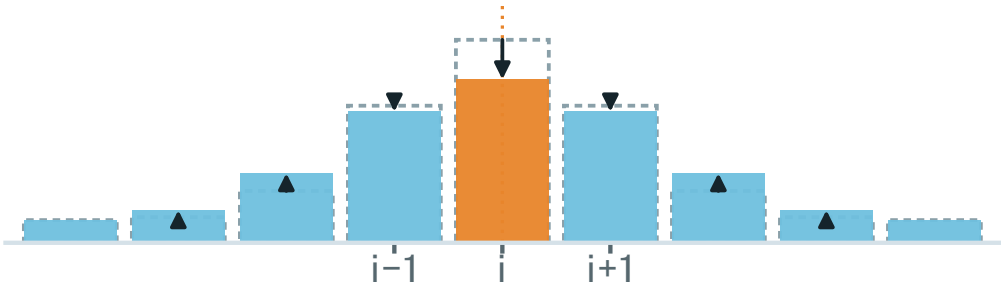


4 Slide the stencil: rates f_i



5 Time step

$$u_i^{k+1} = u_i^k + \Delta t\, f_i$$

explicit Euler; RK4 or any scheme that evaluates f can replace it

6 Next state u_i^{k+1} (dashed: u_i^k)